

established a Center of Excellence for cancer diseases at Government Arignar Anna Memorial Cancer Hospital in Karapettai, Kancheepuram, at a cost of Rs 120 crore. The Government Institute of Rehabilitation Medicine in KK Nagar, Chennai, was also upgraded as a Center of Excellence. Also implemented is the Manam Scheme to prevent suicides among youth, particularly students, by promoting mental health awareness.

HOUSING AND URBAN DEVELOPMENT

The Tamil Nadu Housing Board (TNHB) has issued 2298 allotment orders and 488 sale deeds in Tamil language, benefiting numerous individuals. Additionally, sale deeds were provided to 9313 allottees, and special camps and sale deed melas were conducted regularly across all divisions and units of TNHB. Under the TNHB, three projects were initiated in Madurai, Salem, and Gudiyatham, involving 615 units at a cost of Rs 25.76 Crore. The Tamil Nadu Apartment Ownership Act (Amendment) Bill, 2022, was passed, and rules for implementing the Act were in progress.

WELFARE OF NON-RESIDENT TAMILS

The Commissionerate of Rehabilitation and Welfare of Non-Resident Tamils has focused on the welfare of Sri Lankan Tamils. The department's name was changed to "Ayalaga Tamilar Nalan & Maruvalvuthurai Anaiyaragam" to align with the Government's vision. Measures have been implemented to ensure dignified and secure lives for Sri Lankan Tamils living in Rehabilitation Camps. As part of this, the names of "Sri Lankan Refugee camps" have been changed to "Sri Lankan Tamils Rehabilitation Camps."

TRANSPORT

The Transport Department has achieved significant milestones in improving public transportation in Tamil Nadu. These include the implementation of fare-free travel for women, transgender individuals, and 40% differently-abled passengers and their assistants in city buses. The department has also introduced 206 new routes, along with the resumption of 409 routes, enhancing connectivity and accessibility for commuters. During festival seasons and on a daily basis, special buses operate to various cities from Chennai. A Grievance Whatsapp Group has been established to enable swift redressal of concerns of travellers. Efforts have been made to expand and modernize the fleet. The department allocated Rs 420 crore for the procurement of 1,000 new buses in the fiscal year 2022-23, while also dedicating Rs 80 crore for refurbishing 1,000 old buses. Additionally, 2,213 BS-VI diesel buses and 500 electric buses have been procured, promoting cleaner and greener transportation. To enhance payment convenience, the National General Mobility Card has been implemented in Chennai.

HIGHWAYS

The Highways Department constructed 832.09 kms of roads and 474 bridges/culverts, costing Rs 2,311.15 crore under the Comprehensive Road Infrastructure Development Programme. Additionally, they improved 423.67 kms of roads at a cost of Rs 346.53 crore through the Improvements to Riding Quality Programme. Road safety initiatives included 373 works costing Rs 131.19 crore under the Comprehensive Road Infrastructure Development Programme and 66 works costing Rs 56.95 crore under the Road Safety Scheme. The construction of 25 high-level bridges (Rs. 98.97 Crore) and the conversion of 123 causeways into high-level bridges were significant accomplishments.



PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

PWD has constructed the Kalaignar Library at the Ulaga Tamil Sangam campus in Madurai, at an estimated cost of Rs 114 crore. In Chennai, it has erected a Memorial Pillar at a cost of Rs 1.95 crore to commemorate the 75th year of Indian Independence. Additionally, a full-size bronze statue of Mahatma Gandhi was erected in front of the National Art Gallery in the Government Museum, Chennai. The PWD has also made progress on various construction projects, including a memorial for Muthamizh Arignar Dr. Kalaignar in Chennai, at a cost of Rs 39 crore and a Jallikattu auditorium in Keelakarai village, Madurai, at a cost of Rs 44 crore.

In the healthcare sector, the PWD has initiated the construction of a Multi Super Specialty hospital at the King Institute of Preventive Medicine & Research in Guindy, Chennai. The project, estimated to cost Rs 230 crore, has reached 75% completion. Additionally, the PWD has contributed to the establishment of 11 new Government Industrial Training Institutes, aimed at meeting industry standards, with an estimated cost of Rs 45.91 crore.

WATER RESOURCES

Over the past two years, the Water Resources Department has made significant progress in managing water resources and enhancing irrigation systems in Tamil Nadu. In 2021-22, the Mettur Dam was opened on schedule, providing water for Kuruvai irrigation in the Cauvery delta. In 2022-23, the dam was opened in advance, ensuring sufficient water supply to the tail end area. Meanwhile, the water level of Mullai Periyar Dam was maintained at 142 ft for 18 days, optimizing its storage capacity. Extensive desilting works were undertaken across the state. In the Cauvery Delta area alone, 683 desilting projects covering a length of 4964.11 Km were completed, amounting to Rs 80 cr.